EMPANADA DE ZORZA / RAXO

YIELD	REST	OVEN	ENERGY COST
Filling for 1 large empanada (tin of about 32 cm)	**36-48 h (marinating the zorza)**	**195 °C, 45-50 min**	**$2.75 (50 min bake plus 30 min, 3.5 kW at 59 cents/kWh)**

INGREDIENTS

500 g	Lean pork (aguja or raxo), in small pieces
2-3	Garlic cloves
5 g	Sweet pimentón de la Vera
3 g	Hot pimentón
1 tsp	Dried oregano
no quantity given	Coarse salt
2-3 tbsp	Extra virgin olive oil for the majado
2 (about 400 g), with 1 tsp sweet pimentón	Large onions
to taste	Piquillo or roasted peppers (optional)

METHOD

1. Make the zorza 36-48 h ahead: pound oil, garlic, salt, oregano and both pimentóns into a majado, mix it through the meat, cover and refrigerate, stirring every 8-10 h. It goes into the empanada RAW.
2. Sweat the onion with salt. Off the heat stir in 1 tsp sweet pimentón, then cool completely.
3. Spread the cold onion over the dough base.
4. Scatter the raw zorza and the peppers over the top.
5. Cover, seal, cut a chimney, prick the top and brush with egg.
6. Bake at 195 °C for 45-50 min, then cool on a rack before cutting.

NOTES

The trick: the meat goes in raw but already marinated, and cooks inside the dough in its own juices, so it comes out extremely tender instead of drying out.
Marinate well ahead, 36-48 h. That is what turns plain lean pork into real Galician zorza.
Cut the meat into small, even pieces so it distributes properly.
Add the pimentón to the onion off the heat so it does not turn bitter.
The onion must be cold before assembling. Warm onion softens the dough.
Cool the baked empanada on a rack before cutting so it sets.

DATE ___ / ___ / ___ RATING ___ / 5 OVEN ADJ _____

NOTES _____

_____